

Lesson 108: Play As If



1



ASSUME

the necessary conditions for success.

2



DON'T DELAY:

if the finesse **MUST** work, do it **NOW** (not later).

3



ORDER:

start with the most **RISKY** suit (the one that can go wrong).

4



DISCARD LOSING HYPOTHESES:

if a distribution will make you go down anyway, don't worry about it.

5



ANALYSIS OF NECESSARY HYPOTHESES:

- 1 What **MUST** be true for the contract to succeed?
- 2 → List of conditions
- 3 → Eliminate the impossible ones
- 4 → Play **AS IF** the remaining ones were true.

5

ANALYSIS OF NECESSARY HYPOTHESES



What **MUST** be true for the contract to succeed?



List of conditions

- Condition 1
- Condition 2
- Condition 3
- ...



Eliminate the impossible ones.



Play **AS IF** the remaining ones were true.

Hypothesis A:
contract made



Hypothesis B:
contract down anyway



CHOOSE A!

PRACTICAL EXAMPLE: ASSUME THE KING ON THE LEFT AND PLAY ACCORDINGLY



THE SITUATION

You are South.
Contract: 4♥

You need hearts to break 3-3.
There is a chance the King of Hearts is on your left (West).

OUR NECESSARY HYPOTHESES

- The King of Hearts is on West.
- Hearts break 3-3.
- All other suits behave.



PLAY AS IF THESE ARE TRUE!

Take the finesse now while the entry (♣ A) is safe.

NORTH		SOUTH	
♠ K J 10 6	♠ 9 7 4 3	♠ Q 5	♠ A 8 2
♥ Q J 7 5	♥ K 10 8 4	♥ 2	♥ A 9 6 3
♦ A Q 9 6	♦ J 7 5	♦ 3 2	♦ K 10 8 4
♣ 9 4 2	♣ Q 7 5	♣ A J 6 3	♣ K 10 8

WEST: 4♥ EAST: 4♥

We **ASSUME** the King of Hearts is on West and play accordingly.

HOW TO PLAY

- 1 Cash the ♣ A.



- 2 Lead a heart toward the King.



- 3 West wins with the K♥.



- 4 Continue hearts. Hearts break 3-3, and the contract is made!

